



The Wolfpack's Guide to AI

The five building blocks of AI, in plain language — InspiredBI × Cheyney University

1 Generative AI (GenAI) — Creates net-new content

Produces brand-new text, code, images, audio, or video from a prompt — content that never existed before.

Plain version: a sophisticated remix of the patterns it learned from human-made examples.

2 Large Language Models (LLMs) — The engine behind text AI

Predicts the next word (token) over and over to build fluent, useful answers.

Plain version: the world's most sophisticated autocomplete.

3 Large Multimodal Models (LMMs) — Sees, hears, and reads at once

Understands and creates across text, images, audio, and video in a single conversation.

Plain version: if an LLM reads, an LMM reads and looks and listens.

4 Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) — Grounds AI in your trusted knowledge

Looks up real, approved information first, then answers from it — far fewer hallucinations.

Plain version: open-book instead of from-memory.

5 Agentic AI (AI Agents) — From answering to doing

Give it a goal; it plans the steps, uses tools, and works through a multi-step task to a finish.

Plain version: an assistant who actually carries out the plan, step by step.

Bias check before you rely on any AI output: Who is missing? Whose perspective dominates?